Learning Process Journal

What is a Learning Process Journal?

This Learning Process Journal (LPJ) is designed to get you thinking about the processes you go through as a learner, your strengths and weaknesses, and how to build on the former and improve the latter. The journal is also an opportunity to open a dialogue with your tutor, as it will allow your tutor to offer you more personal and complete feedback in response to your particular learning experience.

The LPJ is a required component of this course, worth 6% of your final grade.

Instructions

1. After completing each module, fill out an entry in the LPJ for the module's assignment. A journal entry consists of answers about the module and the assignment-writing process. The questions asked aim to get you thinking about your learning experience throughout the module and as your wrote your assignment.

2. Be brief. The LPJ is designed to help you, not burden you. Just provide enough feedback (approximately 50–60 words) to give your tutor a sense of how you are doing as you go through the course and what feedback will help you reflect on your learning process.

3. As prompted, answer some questions **before** you write each assignment and one **after** you have completed it.

Evaluation Criteria

- Accurate identification of writing errors in assignments;
- Setting of worthwhile improvement goals;
- Identification and application of effective improvement strategies.

Module 1

Assignment 1

Reflecting on the Module (Complete **before** you have written Assignment 1)

1. How did you find this module? Were there particular things you found especially interesting, particular sections or readings you found challenging or even overly difficult, particular exercises you found helpful? Did you have any struggles with time management?

Honestly, I found the module pretty engaging overall. The piece of strategy on comparing texts' contexts and perspectives was definitely the most engaging aspect. I was hospitalized, so I'm submitting this VERY late, so I suppose I struggled, but not in the most traditional sense.

2. If you struggled with any part of the module, briefly reflect on why you think you did and how you might deal with any problems you may have faced. If you feel you were quite successful as you went through the module, what studying or time-management strategies do you think helped you most?

Yes, I definitely struggled with overall understanding. I was reflecting a lot of "what is the overall point" when I was probably better off skimming the overall idea before diving in deeper.

Reflecting on Your Writing (Complete **before** you have written Assignment 1)

3. Before your write your first assignment, we'd like you to consider what your main areas of weakness have been in your previous English courses. To guide you in thinking about what these might be, have a look at the Error Compilation Grid (which you should have downloaded with the LPJ). You'll see there errors of grammar, word choice, punctuation, content, structure, etc. Once you have gone through the grid, write down a few of your main areas of writing weakness and then consider how you might improve them during this course.

Area of Weakness:	Improvement Steps:
Sentence Structure (CS / RO)	Proofreading out loud is the best strategy for me, forcing me not to skip any words.
Topic Sentences (6 / 7 / 9)	Draft topic sentences prior to beginning paragraph
Citation Integration (23, 24, 25)	Find citations prior to writing, as to not make arguments and finding citation after (which can also lead to poor analysis)

Reflecting on Your Assignment (Complete **after** you have written Assignment 1)

4. How did you find the process of writing Formative Evaluation 1 and Assignment 1? For instance, did you face any challenges in understanding the readings, developing your thesis, finding supporting details, organizing your essay outline, expressing your ideas or revising your written expression?

I did face some challenges when reading the academic texts, but it wasn't too bad. I'm a mature student, and most of my reading nowadays comes from technical articles written by not-so-verbally advanced people. So going back to reading complex articles was a challenge. As per essay outlines, I'm used to writing engineering papers, which I normally write an outline for, so not too bad.

Assignment 2

Reflecting on Assignment 1 (Complete **before** you have written Assignment 2)

1. How did you do on Assignment 1? What were the main errors your tutor identified? (Be sure to review the Error Compilation Grid so that you understand the codes used by your tutor.) How can you avoid making these kinds of errors in Assignment 2?

Reflecting on Assignment 2 (Complete **after** you have written Assignment 2)

2. How did you find the process of writing Formative Evaluation 2 and, in particular, Assignment 2? For instance, were there particular areas of weakness in your outline that needed to be worked on? Did you face any challenges in fleshing out your outline into an essay or revising your written expression?

Module 2

Assignment 3

Reflecting on the Module (Complete **before** you have written Assignment 3)

1. How did you find this module? Were there particular things you found especially interesting, particular sections or readings you found challenging or even overly difficult, particular exercises you found helpful? Did you have any struggles with time management?

2. If you struggled with any part of the module, briefly reflect on why you think you did and how you might deal with any problems you may have faced. If you feel you were quite successful as you went through the module, what studying or time-management strategies do you think helped you most?

Reflecting on Your Writing (Complete **before** you have written Assignment 3)

3. Have a look at your tutor's feedback on Assignment 2. What were your main areas of weakness? How might you improve these in Assignment 3?

Area of Weakness:	Improvement Steps:

Reflecting on Your Assignment (Complete **after** you have written Assignment 3)

4. How did you find the process of writing Formative Evaluation 3 and Assignment 3? For instance, did you face any challenges in understanding the discourses you chose for your oral, developing your thesis, finding supporting details, outlining your oral, or revising your written expression?

Assignment 4

Reflecting on Assignment 4 (Complete **before** you have recorded Assignment 4)

1. How did you do on Assignment 3? What were the main errors your tutor identified in it? How can you work to improve these in preparation for Assignment 4?

Reflecting on Assignment 4 (Complete **after** you have written and recorded Assignment 4)

2. How did you find the process of doing Formative Evaluation 4 and Assignment 4? For instance, for the assignment, did you face any challenges in incorporating your tutor's feedback on the oral outline, or in recording your oral or creating your PowerPoint slides?

Module 3

Assignment 5

Reflecting on the Module (Complete **before** you have written Assignment 5)

1. How did you find this module? Were there particular things you found especially interesting, particular sections or readings you found challenging or even overly difficult, particular exercises you found helpful? Did you have any struggles with time management?

2. If you struggled with any part of the module, briefly reflect on why you think you did. If you feel you were quite successful as you went through the module, what studying or time-management strategies do you think helped you most?

Reflecting on Your Writing (Complete **before** you have written Assignment 5)

3. Have a look at your tutor's feedback on Assignment 4. What were your main areas of weakness? How might you learn from these to improve Assignment 5? Since the outline you write for this assignment will not be graded by your tutor, are there questions you think you should ask your tutor by email or phone in preparation for this assignment?

Reflecting on Your Assignment (Complete **after** you have written Assignment 5)

4. How did you find the process of writing Assignment 5? For instance, did you face any challenges in understanding the discourses you chose to discuss, in developing a thesis, finding supporting details, outlining, writing the essay, or revising your written expression?